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VOL. 7 · ST. ANDREW NORTH WEST

The Crossover That Paid: Delma Thomas Wins Under a New Flag

Delma Thomas won St. Andrew North West for the NNP in 2022, left the party in 2023 and joined the NDC government. In 2026 she won again, by 785 votes, under the other party's colours. Her personal vote went with her.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. ANDREW NORTH WEST, GRENADA

ST. ANDREW NORTH WEST, GRENADA—In 2022 Delma Thomas held St. Andrew North West for the New National Party by 131 votes, 1,898 to 1,767 for the NDC's Gloria Thomas. It was one of only six seats the NNP kept as it lost government.

> **"A party that cannot keep its own members cannot keep their seats."**
> GREG HOSTEN

In 2026 Ms. Thomas won the seat again, by 2,242 votes to 1,457, a majority of 785. This time she was the NDC's candidate. The NNP's Marcia Francis finished second, and the DPM's Olvine Holas took 39. A seat the NNP held four years ago is now one of the NDC's safer ones, and it got there by changing sides with its member.

A MEMBER WHO WALKED

Ms. Thomas was first elected for St. Andrew North West in 2013 and served as a minister in the NNP government. On 8 May 2023 she resigned from the NNP with immediate effect, saying her attempts to represent the constituency from within the party had been frustrated. Two weeks later she announced at a public meeting, alongside Prime Minister Dickon Mitchell, that she would work with the NDC government.

She later joined the Cabinet. The New Today reported that her break with the NNP followed disagreements with Dr. Keith Mitchell over his succession. Whatever the full reasons, the NNP lost a sitting member less than a year after the 2022 election, and with her, the seat.

HER VOTE WENT WITH HER

The results show how much of the NNP's 2022 vote in St. Andrew North West belonged to Ms. Thomas personally. The NNP's vote fell by 441, from 1,898 to 1,457. The NDC's rose by 475, from 1,767 to 2,242. The NNP's share of the two-party vote dropped from 51.8 per cent to 39.4 per cent, a fall of 12.4 points, against 10.3 points nationally.

That extra two points is the measure of the crossover. In most seats the NNP fell by around the national swing or less. Here it fell further, because the party's former member was now standing against it and took part of its base with her.

THE OPPOSITE OF THE TOWN OF ST. GEORGE

The contrast with the Town of St. George is instructive. There, Peter David left the NNP, founded his own party and took 730 votes. That split the opposition and handed the seat to the NDC by three votes.

Ms. Thomas did something different. She did not start a new party. She joined the government. Instead of splitting the vote, she brought her supporters into the larger party, and the result was a comfortable win rather than a narrow loss. For a departing NNP member, the second route proved far more effective.

ONE DIVISION LEFT

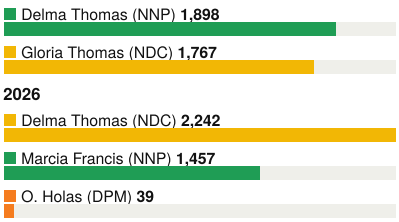
The polling-division results show how thoroughly the seat changed hands. The NNP carried just 1 of the 16 divisions: the Paraclete Government School, by 99 votes to 80.

Everywhere else it lost, and in some places heavily. At the Paradise Medical Station the NNP won only 30.5 per cent of the two-party vote across two divisions. At Paul's Bakery in Birchgrove it took 33.4 per cent. Even at La Fillette, the largest polling site with four divisions, it managed only 41.7 per cent.

The DPM's 39 votes were concentrated at Sio's Bar in Birchgrove, where it took 26. They did not affect the outcome.

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



785 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

785
NDC winning margin, after an NNP majority of 131 in 2022

1 of 16
Polling divisions won by the NNP

–12.4 pts
Fall in the NNP's two-party share, more than nationally

2 of 6
NNP members elected in 2022 who left the party before 2026

TURNOUT FELL, TOO

In 2022 St. Andrew North West had the highest turnout in Grenada, at 76.7 per cent. In 2026 it fell to 69.1 per cent. The register grew by 634 names, but only 71 more ballots were cast. This year 1,681 registered voters did not vote.

Measured against the whole electorate, the NNP won the votes of 39.6 per cent of all registered voters in 2022 and 26.8 per cent in 2026. The NDC rose from 36.8 to 41.3 per cent. The seat did not just switch. It switched decisively.

WHY IT MATTERS BEYOND ST. ANDREW

The NNP lost two of its six 2022 members to departures before the 2026 election: Ms. Thomas in 2023 and Mr. David in January 2025. Both seats were lost. In St. Andrew North West the member took her voters to the government. In the Town the member took his voters to a new party and split the opposition.

A party that cannot keep its own members cannot keep their seats. Of all the lessons in this series, that one may be the most uncomfortable for the NNP, because it is not about the NDC at all. It is about how the party treats the people it has already elected.

THREE HUNDRED AND NINETY-THREE VOTERS

To win the seat back, the NNP needs 393 voters to switch sides, or 786 more supporters to turn out, almost half of those who stayed home. That is a large task in a seat of 5,432 voters, especially against a sitting minister with a long personal record in the constituency.

But there is one advantage. Ms. Thomas's personal vote was built over many years, partly as an NNP member. Some of the voters who followed her in 2026 were NNP voters before. Those voters can be won back, by a candidate and a party that give them a reason.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE NORTH-WEST

St. Andrew North West is a long-term project. The plan must start with the candidate and the party's own house.

Year one, 2027: choose a candidate who lives in the constituency and commit to that person for two elections. Open a permanent office. Meet the branch members who stayed with the NNP after 2023 and rebuild the household list from scratch, starting with Paraclete, the one division the party still holds.

Year two, 2028: concentrate on La Fillette and Mirabeau, the two largest polling sites, where the NNP took about 41 per cent. Small gains there move the whole seat. Hold regular meetings with farmers, transport operators, young people and families in Birchgrove and Paradise.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 16 divisions. Hold the sitting member to account in public on what she has delivered as a minister for St. Andrew North West, measured against her own promises.

Year four, 2030: campaign for the voters who were NNP voters before 2023. The target is 393 switchers, and the starting point is the 441 NNP votes lost since 2022.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

Elected members are the party's most valuable asset, and the hardest to replace. When they leave, they take part of the vote with them, either to the other side or to a new party. The NNP lost two members after 2022, and it lost both seats in 2026.

Keeping members inside the tent requires a party that listens to them, resolves disputes internally and settles its leadership in a way they can accept. That is national work, not constituency work, but every seat in this series depends on it.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. ANDREW NORTH WEST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	1,898	1,457	−441
NDC votes	1,767	2,242	+475
Delma Thomas's party	NNP	NDC	crossed in 2023
NNP share of two-party vote	51.8%	39.4%	−12.4 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NNP +131	NDC +785	916-vote swing
Registered voters	4,798	5,432	+634
Turnout	76.7%	69.1%	−7.6 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,118	1,681	+563
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	39.6%	26.8%	−12.8 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		1 of 16	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		393	

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates (2026: DPM 39). 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 16 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Keep your elected members: a departing MP takes part of the vote with them.
2. A member who joins the other side is more damaging than one who splits off.
3. Resolve leadership disputes inside the party, before they become resignations.
4. Rebuild from the one division still held: Paraclete.
5. Target La Fillette and Mirabeau, the two largest polling sites.
6. Win back former NNP voters who followed their member in 2023.
7. Captain all 16 divisions, with a permanent office.
8. Target 393 switchers, starting with the 441 votes lost since 2022.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2022 general election); NOW Grenada (Delma Thomas resignation, 8 May 2023; 'Delma Thomas declares she will work with government', May 2023; Peter David resignation, 21 Jan 2025); Caribbean News Service (Thomas resignation statement); The New Today (Thomas and NNP succession; cabinet reshuffle). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 7 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.